

Veterans Backbone

Training, Competency & Professional Standards Policy Suite

Purpose

This policy suite establishes how Veterans Backbone develops, supports, supervises, and maintains competent individuals across all roles.

Training is not treated as a one-off event or a compliance exercise. It exists to ensure that veterans receive safe, professional, consistent, and accountable support.

This suite applies to employees, volunteers, trustees, contractors, and external professionals operating within Veterans Backbone.

Policy 1 – Training, Supervision & Support

Purpose

To ensure individuals receive the knowledge, support, and supervision required to perform their role safely and effectively.

Core Principles

- Training must be appropriate to role.
- Learning is ongoing.
- Supervision supports wellbeing and accountability.
- Nobody should carry significant responsibility without support.

Requirements

Veterans Backbone will:

- Provide mandatory training.
 - Provide role-specific training where required.
 - Maintain training records.
 - Provide appropriate supervision.
 - Review training requirements periodically.
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Policy 2 – Induction & Onboarding

Purpose

To ensure all individuals begin their role safely, consistently, and with a clear understanding of expectations.

Minimum Induction Requirements

Induction may include:

- Introduction to Veterans Backbone
- Safeguarding responsibilities
- Professional boundaries
- Health & Safety
- Data Protection
- Site rules and procedures
- Emergency arrangements
- Role-specific expectations

No individual should commence unsupervised duties without appropriate induction.

Policy 3 – Competency & Role Readiness

Purpose

To ensure individuals are only assigned responsibilities appropriate to their competence, experience, and training.

Core Principles

- Competence before responsibility.
- Support before escalation.
- Training should match role requirements.
- Additional support should be available where needed.

Expectations

Individuals should:

- Work within their competence.
- Seek guidance where uncertain.
- Declare limitations honestly.
- Participate in development activities.

Managers and supervisors should:

- Assess readiness.
 - Provide support.
 - Monitor development.
 - Restrict duties where competence concerns exist.
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Policy 4 – Professional Supervision

Purpose

To provide structured support, accountability, reflection, and oversight.

Supervision Objectives

Supervision may be used to:

- Review workload.
- Discuss safeguarding concerns.
- Explore professional challenges.
- Support wellbeing.
- Identify development needs.
- Maintain professional standards.

Core Principle

Supervision exists to support people, not police them.

No member of staff or volunteer should be expected to hold significant responsibility entirely alone.

Policy 5 – Continuing Professional Development (CPD)

Purpose

To promote continual learning and improvement across Veterans Backbone.

Acceptable Development Activities

Examples include:

- Refresher training
- Workshops
- Conferences

- Mentoring
- Coaching
- Peer learning
- Professional qualifications
- Independent learning

Expectations

Learning should:

- Remain relevant to role.
- Improve competence.
- Support organisational standards.
- Contribute to safer practice.

Certificates alone do not demonstrate competence.

Application of learning remains the most important measure.

Training Records & Compliance

Veterans Backbone maintains appropriate records relating to:

- Induction completion
- Mandatory training
- Refresher training
- Role-specific training
- Supervision activity
- CPD activity

Records support accountability, quality assurance, safeguarding, and organisational learning.

Learning From Mistakes

Mistakes should be addressed honestly and constructively.

Where issues arise the focus should be:

- Understanding what happened.
- Reducing future risk.
- Supporting learning.
- Improving systems.
- Maintaining accountability.

The objective is improvement rather than blame.

Review & Oversight

This policy suite is reviewed periodically and whenever significant operational, legal, safeguarding, or organisational changes occur.

Material amendments may be recorded through the Adaptive Stewardship process where appropriate.

Final Statement

Veterans Backbone does not expect perfection.

We do expect people to remain curious, accountable, willing to learn, and prepared to seek support when needed.

Training is not about collecting certificates.

It is about ensuring the right people have the right knowledge, support, judgement, and standards to serve veterans safely and effectively.